

Space Exploration Technologies Corp.

(SpaceX • Nasdaq: SPCX)

Post-IPO Research Note — First-Trading-Day Reaction

Debut June 12, 2026 • Offer \$135.00 • First-day close \$160.95 (+19.2%)

June 15, 2026

Prepared with Claude • Research powered by Bigdata.com

This note assesses the first trading session. It contains no recommendation, price target, or conviction rating.

1. Executive Summary

Field	Day-1 value
Issuer / Ticker / Exchange	Space Exploration Technologies Corp. / SPCX / Nasdaq Global Select & Nasdaq Texas [22]
Offer price (vs range)	\$135.00 fixed price — no marketing range; ~555.6M Class A shares; ~\$75B raised [1][22]
Opening print	\$150.00 (+11.1% vs offer); pre-open indications had ranged \$155–\$175 [4][8]
Intraday high / low	High \$176.52 (~+30.8%); opening print \$150 the effective low of the regular session [6][4]
First-day close	\$160.95 [1]
First-day return	+19.22% = (\$160.95 – \$135.00) / \$135.00 [1][10]
Volume / turnover	~508–510M shares; ~\$84–85B traded — ~0.91x the 555.6M shares offered [1][7]
Implied market cap at close	~\$2.1 trillion (vs ~\$1.77T at the offer); ~6th–7th most valuable US company [10][7]
Free float (% of shares out)	<5% of shares outstanding at listing — record dollar size, very thin float [12][14]
After-hours	+~3% to ~\$166.76, pushing market cap toward ~\$2.2T [9]

The largest IPO in history priced, then popped. SpaceX sold ~555.6M Class A shares at a fixed \$135 to raise ~\$75 billion, opened at \$150 (+11.1%), traded as high as \$176.52 (+30.8%), and closed its first session at \$160.95 — a **+19.22% first-day return** that lifted the implied market capitalization from ~\$1.77 trillion at the offer to ~\$2.1 trillion at the close [1][6][10]. The debut made SpaceX one of the six-to-seven most valuable listed companies in the world and, on paper, made Elon Musk the first trillionaire [7][22].

Demand-driven, but on a wafer-thin float. The order book topped \$250–350 billion (about 3–4x the offering), and an unusually large ~20% retail allocation met a free float under 5% of shares outstanding [7][18]. With so little stock available, the move reflects scarcity and Musk-premium enthusiasm at least as much as fundamental price discovery; the opening print of \$150 came in below the ~\$174 pre-open indication, a sign institutional bidding tempered the early speculative froth [4].

Orderly mechanics; price discovery is just beginning. Trading opened late Friday morning without the system failures that marred Facebook's 2012 debut, and ~0.91x of the entire offering changed hands [7]. But the FT cautions “we haven't seen anything resembling market pricing yet” — both supply and demand remain in flux ahead of staggered index inclusion and the first lock-up unlocks [12].

The debate is price, not the debut. At the close SpaceX traded at roughly 112x trailing FY2025 revenue — richer than any megacap — even as it remains loss-making and cash-hungry. Bulls frame it as “the railroads of the space economy”; skeptics, including Jim Chanos and Morningstar, call the valuation untethered [7][16]. This note draws no fair-value conclusion.

2. Deal Recap

SpaceX priced ~555.6 million Class A common shares at a fixed \$135.00 on June 11, raising roughly \$75 billion — the largest IPO on record, surpassing Saudi Aramco's 2019 deal by a wide margin [1][22]. Unusually, the company set a single fixed price rather than marketing a range and building a book, leaving bankers “with less flexibility than is typical” [12]. The offering is expected to close on June 15, and underwriters hold a 30-day greenshoe option to buy up to ~83.3 million additional Class A shares at the \$135 IPO price (an over-allotment the FT values near \$11 billion) [2][12].

Goldman Sachs led a ~21-bank syndicate alongside Morgan Stanley, Bank of America, Citigroup and JPMorgan [4]. Allocation skewed toward holders the deal team judged long-term: per the FT, ~70% went to long-only managers, sovereign wealth funds and longtime Musk associates, ~20% to retail (roughly double the typical IPO), and hedge funds were squeezed to ~10% of the book [18]. Proceeds are earmarked to fund AI compute and launch infrastructure and to repay the SpaceX bridge loan within six months [26]. The fixed-price, thin-float, retail-heavy structure framed the day-1 dynamics that followed.

3. Day-1 Price Action

After executives rang the Nasdaq opening bell, pre-open indications swung widely — first as high as ~\$174–175 (~+29%), then trimmed toward ~\$155 — before the stock opened at \$150, an 11.1% premium to the \$135 offer [3][8][4]. Trading was volatile but broadly higher: SPCX climbed to an intraday high of \$176.52 (nearly +31%) around midday before pulling back into the close [6][10].

Metric	Value	Return vs \$135 offer
Offer price	\$135.00	—
Opening print	\$150.00	+11.1%
Intraday high	\$176.52	+30.8%
First-day close	\$160.95	+19.22%
After-hours	~\$166.76	~+23.5%
Day-1 volume	~508–510M shares (~\$84–85B)	~0.91x shares offered

First-day return = $(\$160.95 \text{ close} - \$135.00 \text{ offer}) / \$135.00 = +19.22\%$. Turnover = $\sim 508\text{M traded} / 555.6\text{M offered} \approx 0.91\text{x}$. Figures from cited market reports (Benzinga Pro, Reuters); intraday prints may vary slightly across data vendors.

The close settled roughly 9% below the intraday peak, a give-back consistent with profit-taking after a ~31% spike on a name with little tradable supply [10]. Volume neared the level set by Facebook's 2012 debut, and dollar turnover of ~\$84–85 billion underscored how much capital rotated through a single session [7]. No underwriter stabilization or greenshoe exercise had been disclosed as of this writing; with the stock holding well above the \$135 offer all day, price support was not obviously needed [2]. The stock added another ~3% after hours, signaling demand had not been exhausted at the bell [9].

4. Demand & Float Mechanics

The defining technical feature is scarcity. SpaceX floated under 5% of shares outstanding even at a record dollar size, against an order book reported at \$250–350 billion — roughly 3–4x the offering [7][14]. A thin float amplifies moves in both directions: with little stock to satisfy buyers, modest incremental demand can drive outsized price gains, and the same illiquidity can magnify declines when sentiment turns. Analysts and PMs explicitly flagged that investors should “brace for volatility” given the small relative float and high valuation [7].

Retail demand was a distinguishing feature: SpaceX allocated ~20% of the deal to retail (about double the norm), and Robinhood reported record platform traffic and brief outages on debut day, with some investors celebrating allocations of a single share [11][21]. The FT’s read on the book — ~70% long-only and sovereign-wealth, hedge funds cut to ~10% — suggests the deal team deliberately seeded the register with holders less likely to flip [18]. On balance, the day-1 move looks more demand- and scarcity-driven than stabilization-supported, but it is not yet a clean read on fundamental value: as the FT put it, real price discovery is still ahead [12].

5. Valuation Reset at the Close

The first-day pop re-rated SpaceX from ~\$1.77 trillion at the offer to ~\$2.1 trillion at the close. On trailing FY2025 revenue of \$18.67 billion, that lifts the price-to-revenue multiple from ~95x at the offer to ~112x at the close — a level Reuters and others flag as far above any megacap [7][10]. Because the IPO raised ~\$75 billion of cash against ~\$29 billion of debt, enterprise value is close to (or below) market cap, so EV/Sales is in a similar zone; precise net-debt figures post-raise are not yet disclosed.

Reference point	Implied multiple / value	Basis
SPCX at offer (\$135; ~\$1.77T)	~95x FY25 revenue	FY25 rev \$18.67B [7]
SPCX at first-day close (\$160.95; ~\$2.1T)	~112x FY25 revenue	Reuters [7]
Nvidia / Magnificent 7	All lower EV/Sales than SPCX	Pre-IPO comp set [16]
Tesla (TSLA)	~14x sales	Chanos [16]
S&P; 500 aerospace & defense (12 names)	SPCX > combined value of all 12	R. Reich, via Benzinga [24]
Independent estimates	Morningstar <\$1T; Goldman bulls model 100x revenue by 2030	[16]

On every disclosed metric the close screens rich versus listed peers; bulls counter that no listed company combines launch, satellite broadband and a vertically integrated AI stack, so the comparison set is itself contested [17]. What it would take to grow into the price is steep: bullish sum-of-the-parts cases lean on SpaceX reaching hundreds of billions in revenue by 2030, and Musk himself called a ~\$330B–\$1T 2030 revenue projection something the company “might be able to reach” [17]. **This note draws no fair-value conclusion.**

6. Sentiment & Coverage

Bigdata.com coverage over the debut skewed euphoric but increasingly two-sided. Media framed the day as validation of investor appetite for “moonshots” and a green light for the OpenAI and Anthropic listings behind it; one PM said SpaceX is “the closest thing to investing in the railroads during the Industrial Revolution” [7][21]. Cross-asset reaction was telling: lead underwriter Goldman Sachs rose ~2.6% on IB-fee expectations, AT&T and Verizon gained ~2.5% after S&P/MSCI GICS classified SpaceX into Telecommunication Services, while space peers sold off as funds rotated into the new name — Rocket Lab ~-10.8%, Firefly ~-19.1%, AST SpaceMobile ~-15.5%, Intuitive Machines ~-13.1% [13].

The bear thread is persistent: short-seller Jim Chanos called the valuation untethered to its ~\$18B revenue and losses, Morningstar pegged intrinsic value below \$1 trillion, and at least one large short position was opened around the debut [16][23]. **Quiet-period caveat:** the underwriter-affiliated banks (Goldman, Morgan Stanley, BofA, Citi, JPMorgan) are restricted from publishing ratings during the post-IPO quiet period, so there is no syndicate sell-side consensus yet — the loudest voices so far are media, independent analysts and short-sellers, not initiating-coverage research [16][17].

7. Post-IPO Timeline & Watch Points

The near-term setup is dominated by staggered, largely price-insensitive index buying against an eventual wave of lock-up supply. KB Securities maps the passive calendar in detail; BNP Paribas estimates over \$16 billion of index-linked demand within 15 trading days of the debut (more if the greenshoe is filled) [12][14].

Date (approx.)	Event	Why it matters
Jun 15, 2026	Offering closes; single-stock leveraged/inverse ETFs begin trading	Adds geared two-way flow [14]
Jun 16, 2026	SPCX listed options open	New hedging/leverage channel [9]
Jun 19, 2026	FTSE Russell & CRSP (Vanguard) inclusion (~5 trading days)	~\$7–10B combined w/ MSCI [14][19]
Jun 26, 2026	MSCI inclusion (~10 trading days)	Further passive buying [14]
~Jul 6, 2026	Nasdaq-100 fast-track inclusion (~15 trading days)	Wt ~0.44–0.50%; ~\$6.2–7.1B buying [14]
~Mid-Jul 2026	First Q2 earnings; quiet-period end / analyst initiations	First syndicate ratings; partial lock-up unlock [12]
~Dec 2026	180-day lock-up expiry; float toward 15–20%	Large supply step-up [26]
~Jun 2027	366-day founder/major-investor lock-up expiry	Musk shares eligible [26]

Bull read of the setup. A three-week cascade of forced passive buying meets a sub-5% float and a holder base seeded with long-only money — a technical squeeze that could keep the stock bid into July [12][14].

Bear read of the setup. The same index changes drew formal objections from New York, Illinois, Maryland and Oregon pension funds, who warn early inclusion of a thin-float, richly valued name transfers risk to passive holders [20]. Supply is the offset: per the prospectus (via FT), up to ~911 million insider shares become eligible the day after Q2 earnings — rising toward ~1.4 billion if the stock is above \$175.50 that day — with nearly 3.3 billion more eligible by year-end, against just 555.6 million sold in the IPO [12][26]. S&P; 500 entry remains blocked for now by the GAAP-profitability requirement [13]. Historically, large tech IPOs have seen steep first-year drawdowns, a base rate worth holding in mind [9].

Sources

- [1] Bigdata.com / Benzinga — “SpaceX Stock Closes Up 19% In Record-Shattering IPO Debut” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/A9F8830E0A10FDF8CB2E2295ECECC5A5>
- [2] Bigdata.com / MT Newswires — “SpaceX Jumps 21% as Blockbuster Debut Pushes Market Valuation Above \$2 Trillion” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/D3413F6B97A1CF83225FB41ECC8B0865>
- [3] Bigdata.com / CNBC — “SpaceX's first trade indicated around \$175 per share ahead of opening” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/841C4196242587989D3F2F9E3FB693D9>
- [4] Bigdata.com / Benzinga — “SpaceX Starts Trading At \$150, Before Rising To \$165: 'Liftoff', Says Elon Musk-Led Company” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/E7909A06B710F226E07C0B7E8FD7A761>
- [5] Bigdata.com / Industrial Securities — “Defense and Military Industry - ... SpaceX Officially Lands on Nasdaq” — Jun 14, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/03B20D4258305474E07657CB00B08527>
- [6] Bigdata.com / CBS News — “SpaceX stock soars 19% on first day of trading following record-breaking \$75 billion IPO” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/34A8FB09C61FF8200B7A2866CB4529A3>
- [7] Bigdata.com / Reuters (via QNB Financial Daily Market Report) — “SpaceX surges past \$2tn in Nasdaq debut, closes in on Amazon” — Jun 14, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/6619616BAB416BDBA9E74E2692E8DA2>
- [8] Bigdata.com / Forbes.com — “SpaceX Could Open At \$155 - As Estimates Fall Ahead Of Blockbuster Debut (Live Updates)” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/07F8D8AF4D4FE0041531623FA7AEB651>
- [9] Bigdata.com / AOL.com — “Veteran hedge fund manager makes a brazen SpaceX bet” — Jun 14, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/C217FDD80566800AC4DE0F58DAB5C6AE>
- [10] Bigdata.com / Eastmoney — “SpaceX Surges 19.22% on First Day of Trading, Becoming Sixth Largest US Company by Market Cap” — Jun 13, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/44AFE4CB07F7DCC8BB13DAD3E9145634>
- [11] Bigdata.com / Nasdaq — “SpaceX Stock Closed Up 19% in Its First Day Of Trading. Should Investors Buy, or Wait?” — Jun 13, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/B014875300A2C157FDD773F75663BDC5>
- [12] Bigdata.com / Financial Times — “SpaceX: no crying at the casino” — Jun 15, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/B0DF5E524CAF805EE42E4C24B54F2193>
- [13] Bigdata.com / KB Securities — “US Market Pulse - Mixed Impact of SpaceX IPO Results on Financials, Telecom, and Space Stocks” — Jun 15, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/88943C5C178EB67200E7C921EB8E0F8A>
- [14] Bigdata.com / KB Securities — “KB ETF - D-1, How to Buy SpaceX with ETFs [Comprehensive]” — Jun 11, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/694582A0724DA2ACFEC162C5454FC97F>
- [15] Bigdata.com / KB Securities — “US Equity Playbook | June | The easing financial environment will accommodate the SpaceX IPO” — May 26, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/33EE57F32BD7B5143CE92CFA20762E71>
- [16] Bigdata.com / Benzinga — “SpaceX Stock Jumped After IPO: Here's Why It May Reverse Soon” — Jun 13, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/C539392BF519636360CA1AE18AA587C7>
- [17] Bigdata.com / CNBC — “SpaceX: To the moon for investors or a bumpy ride? Here's what experts say” — Jun 15, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/EC1068F161E07DD27DCFC696F3F0E530>
- [18] Bigdata.com / Financial Times — “How SpaceX hit its \$2tn valuation” — Jun 15, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/A7F4768E94E7717858FF67C042659498>
- [19] Bigdata.com / KB Securities — “KB ETF Weekly - SpaceX IPO and Passive Funds (3): FTSE, MSCI” — May 28, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/F21F768DD4B9F951EDA1C5D800AD2F40>
- [20] Bigdata.com / KB Securities — “KB Global Tracker+ Weekly - State pension funds raise concerns over early index inclusion” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/EDE584765235FADB535BBB5E1D9D1BA9>
- [21] Bigdata.com / Benzinga — “Jim Cramer Says SpaceX's Mega Debut Could Unleash A Wave Of AI Deals In The Week Ahead” — Jun 13, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/DB888976BB810DF0665A1AC4C2E1AF28>
- [22] Bigdata.com / Nasdaq (RTTNews) — “SpaceX Commences Trading On Nasdaq After Record \$75 Billion IPO” — Jun 12, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/0AE42C911C7E5405052E1D8A4B91DE4B>
- [23] Bigdata.com / AOL.com — “Mysterious trader opens massive SpaceX short ahead of Nasdaq debut” — Jun 13, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/661C04424AB984C85D472FA7EC1A01B7>
- [24] Bigdata.com / Benzinga — “Elon Musk Surpassed J.D. Rockefeller's Wealth Following SPCX IPO ... Peter Schiff” — Jun 15, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/0D674B51247EF65B04C179FA847C90D3>
- [25] Bigdata.com / Charlotte Observer — “SpaceX president says investors should watch Starship, Starlink, Grok” — Jun 14, 2026 — <https://app.bigdata.com/documents/ED147D5F01F442879B920C7A92B83FD6>
- [26] Bigdata.com / Edgar SEC Filings — “SpaceX Form S-1 (public filing)” — May 20, 2026 — <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1181412/000162828026036936/spaceexplorationtechnologi.htm>

Disclaimer

This output is for informational and research-assistance purposes only. It does **not** constitute investment, legal, tax, accounting, or other professional advice, and it is **not** a recommendation to buy, sell, or hold any security or instrument or to pursue any strategy. Information may be incomplete, estimated, delayed, or inaccurate. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Verify material facts independently and consult qualified advisors before making decisions.